Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held in the River Plate Room, Ajax Town Hall
At 1:00 p.m. on November 11, 2019

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
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Present:	Chair - Councillor	R. Tyler Morin, Chair
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	A. Khan
		L. Bower
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Tyler Morin called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting, October 15, 2019

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on October 15, 2019 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Closed Session, October 15, 2019

Moved by: S. Collier

That the Minutes of the Closed Session of the General Government Committee held on October 15, 2019 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.4, 4.5, 4.6, 4.8, 4.9, 4.10, 4.11, 4.13, and 4.14 for discussion.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That items 4.7 and 4.12 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

4.1 Council Expense Policy, Ward Meetings Policy, Council Communications Tools & Support Policy

Committee Members discussed and asked questions regarding publication of a ward councillor newsletter, *Ajax Today* publication, staff support and coordination for ward meetings, conference and seminar budget for regional councillors, support from the corporate social media coordinator, production of branded and promotional materials, content on the Town's website, graphic design support, use of Town mobile signs, and use of e-mail contact lists.

Christie McLardie, Manager of Public and Strategic Affairs and Devon Jarvis, Administrative Assistant – Council, responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed the proposed ward councillor newsletter, use and purpose of the *Ajax Today* publication, support provided by the corporate social media coordinator, and staff capacity and support for members of Council.

Members discussed and considered several amendments to the proposed policies with respect to budget increases for regional councillors, funding for additional promotional marketing material, Council expenses exceeding budget, the ward councillor newsletter and *Ajax Today* publication, and expenses for individual councillor websites. D. Jarvis and C. McLardie further discussed the proposed policies and existing practices.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Lee

That the revised Policy #030 – Council Expense Policy be approved.

That the new Ward Meetings Policy – #142 be approved.

That the new Council Communications Tools & Support Policy – #143 be approved.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That the proposed budget increase for conferences & seminars for regional councillors be removed.

CARRIED

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That section 5.2.5.1 of the proposed Council Expense Policy be amended by removing the words 'additional promotional marketing material'.

CARRIED

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That section 14.1 of the proposed Council Expense Policy be removed.

CARRIED

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That the ward constituent newsletter be removed from the proposed policies and the matter be referred back to staff for further examination.

CARRIED

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That section 5.2.6.1 of the council expense policy be stricken and replaced with the words 'Social media maintenance fees may be covered under the communications budget', and that the title of section 5.2.6. be re-named to 'Social Media'.

MOTION FAILED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Lee

That the revised Policy #030 – Council Expense Policy be approved as amended.

That the new Ward Meetings Policy – #142 be approved as amended.

That the new Council Communications Tools & Support Policy – #143 be approved as amended.

CARRIED

4.2 Capital Account Closing Report, August 31, 2019

Committee Members asked questions regarding contract cost savings and capital reserve spending caps under the Financial Sustainability Plan. Sandra Serrao, Acting Director of Finance, responded to questions from Committee Members and reviewed spending caps under the Financial Sustainability Plan.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That Council receive the attached listing of Capital Account Closings as of August 31, 2019 for information.

2. That funding transfers to/from the Reserves / Reserve Funds from the August 31, 2019 Capital Account Closings, in accordance with the Financial Sustainability Plan, be approved as follows:

Reserve / Reserve Fund	Transfers to	Transfers from	Net Transfer
Capital Contingency Reserve	($1,531.35)		($1,531.35)
Building Maintenance Reserve	($598,745.59)	$20,968.43	($577,777.16)
General Infrastructure Reserve	($84,687.05)		($59,687.05)
Strategic Initiatives Reserve	($2,811.86)		($2,811.86)
Vehicle/Equipment Replacement Reserve	($16,274.70)	$38,283.12	$22,008.42
Storm Water Reserve		$9,253.54	$9,253.54
Total Transfers	($679,050.55)	$95,713.43	($610,545.46)
Approval Only (DC Related)			$27,208.34
Total Approval			($583,337.12)

CARRIED

4.3 Proposed 2020 Fees and Charges for the Finance Department

Committee Members asked questions regarding comparison of fees to other municipalities. S. Serrao and Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services / Town Clerk, responded to questions from Committee Members and reviewed the fee comparison process.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the recommended Finance Department fees be approved, effective January 1, 2020, and that the appropriate By-law(s) be presented to Council.

CARRIED

4.4 2020 Fire & Emergency Service Fees

Committee Members inquired about the collection of fees from non-residents. Aaron Burridge, Deputy Fire Chief, responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed the collection of fees and charges.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the recommended Fire & Emergency Service fees, effective January 1, 2020 be approved and that the appropriate by-law(s) be presented to Council.

CARRIED

4.5 Fire & Emergency Service Motor Vehicle Collision (MVC) Cost Recovery Program for Municipal Roadways (both Town and Regional Roads)

Committee Members asked questions regarding application of similar fees by other municipalities, and reporting back on revenues. A. Burridge responded to questions from Committee Members and reviewed practices across Durham Region.

Moved by: A. Khan

That the Fire & Emergency Service Motor Vehicle Collision (MVC) Cost Recovery Program for Municipal Roadways (both Town and Regional Roads) be approved, and that the associated fees be included in the forthcoming Fire Services User Fee by-law.

CARRIED

The meeting recessed at 2:47 p.m.

The meeting resumed at 2:56 p.m.

4.6 Proposed 2020 Fees and Charges for Legislative and Information Services

Committee Members considered the potential to introduce a fee or deposit for submission of a Code of Conduct complaint to the Town's Integrity Commissioner and asked questions regarding the functional purpose of a fee or deposit, permissibility of a fee or deposit, practices of other municipalities, and potential privacy implications. N. Cooper responded to questions from Committee Members and reviewed the permissibility of a fee or deposit, privacy implications of requiring a fee or deposit, and the practices of other Durham Region municipalities. Committee Members discussed the merits of a fee or deposit.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That the fee schedule be amended to include a $500 deposit for filing a code of conduct complaint to the Town's Integrity Commissioner, refundable where the complaint proceeds to an investigation.

MOTION FAILED

Recorded Vote
In Favour: S. Collier, A. Khan
Opposed: S. Lee, L. Bower, M. Crawford, J. Dies, R. Tyler Morin

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Lee

That the recommended Legislative and Information Services fees be approved, effective January 1, 2020, and that the appropriate By-law(s) be presented to Council.

CARRIED

4.7 2019 Town of Ajax Provincial Accessibility Compliance Report

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the 2019 Town of Ajax Accessibility Compliance Report (ATT-1) be approved for submission to the Ministry for Seniors and Accessibility.

CARRIED

4.8 2019 Temporary Sign By-law

Committee Members asked questions regarding proposed changes to the by-law, temporary signage permitted on Regional roads in Ajax, and timing of funding for additional enforcement of illegal wire-frame signs. Derek Hannan, Manager of By-law Services, responded to questions from Committee members and reviewed the proposed changes to the by-law and signage restrictions on Regional roads. N. Cooper reviewed the timing of funding necessary to continue additional enforcement of illegal wire-frame signs into 2020.

Referral Motion

Moved by: S. Collier

That the addition of $18,000 to the By-law Services Operating Budget, to fund an additional 600 annual part-time staff hours dedicated to twice weekly sweeps for illegal wire-frame signs be referred to the 2020 budget process.

MOTION WITHDRAWN

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the proposed Temporary Sign By-law (ATT-1) be approved by Council; and,

2. That Council approve the addition of $18,000 to the By-law Services Operating Budget, to fund an additional 600 annual part-time staff hours dedicated to twice-weekly sweeps for illegal wire-frame signs.

CARRIED

4.9 Contract Renewal – Wide Area Network (WAN), Internet, SIP Services

Committee Members inquired about provision of high-speed internet service to the Innovation Village project and connection to the Town's network. George Rodrigues, Network Services Supervisor, and N. Cooper responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That Council award the contract for wide area network (WAN), internet and SIP services to Rogers Business Solutions in the estimated amount of $230,500.00, for a period of one year.

2. That Staff be authorized to renew the contract for an additional four, one year periods, pending an analysis and satisfactory performance review at the anniversary date of the contract, in the estimated amount of $922,000.00 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

4.10 Proposed 2020 Operations and Environmental Services User Fees

Committee Members inquired about services provided by the Senior Snow Removal Program, proposed changes to fees and introduction of new fees, determination of needs for outdoor sports facilities, and comparison to fees charged by neighbouring municipalities. Amanda Hynes, Office Supervisor – Operations & Environmental Services, reviewed the Senior Snow Removal Program, proposed changes to user fees, and introduction of new fees. Catherine Bridgeman, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, and Tracey Vaughan, Director of Recreation, Culture & Community Development, discussed evaluation of needs for outdoor sports facilities and the Recreation Master Plan process.

Moved by: A. Khan

That the recommended Operations and Environmental Services fees be approved, effective January 1, 2020, and that the appropriate By-law(s) be presented to Council.

CARRIED

4.11 Proposed 2020 Fees and Charges for Planning & Development Services

Committee Members had no questions regarding this item.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the recommended Planning and Development Services fees be approved, effective January 1, 2020, and that the appropriate By-law(s) be presented to Council.

CARRIED

4.12 Assumption of Subdivisions 18T-99010 Guthrie Phase 1 18T-99010 Guthrie Phase 2

Moved by: M. Crawford

(1) That the works and services within the following Plans of Subdivision be assumed by the Town:

a) (18T-99010) – Guthrie Phase 1
Owner: Runnymede Development Corp Limited
Agreement Date: July 5, 2011
Registered Plan: 40M-2450
Refer to Appendix “A”

b) (18T-99010) – Guthrie Phase 2
Owner: Runnymede Development Corp Limited
Agreement Date: October 12, 2012
Registered Plan: 40M-2486
Refer to Appendix “B”

(2) That the corresponding Assumption By-laws be prepared for an upcoming Council meeting.

CARRIED

4.13 Development Charge Deferral Agreement – 70 Station Street

Committee Members had no questions regarding this item.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the Mayor and Clerk be authorized to execute a Development Charge Deferral Agreement with CSH Ballycliffe Lodge Inc. (ATT-1); and,

2. That, should the Region of Durham approve the deferral of its portion of the Development Charges, the Mayor and Clerk be authorized to execute a three-party agreement (between the Town, the Region, and CSH Ballycliffe Inc.) provided the substance of the agreement applicable to the Town is substantially the same as the two-party agreement (ATT-1).

CARRIED

4.14 Acquisition of Land from Toronto and Region Conservation Authority for Church Street Reconstruction

Committee Members asked questions regarding future installation of a roundabout on Church Street. Geoff Romanowski, Acting Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Committee Members and reviewed phases of development for the Church Street Reconstruction project.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That a by-law to accept the transfer of Part 1 of the attached draft 40R-Plan from the Toronto and Region Conservation Authority, to facilitate the widening of Church Street, be presented to Council for approval at a future meeting.

CARRIED

With the consent of members present, Item 6. (Closed Session) was advanced in the order of business.

Closed Session (3:50 p.m.)

6. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Committee convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) (e) of the *Municipal Act, 2001,* as amended, to discuss matters pertaining to litigation or potential litigation, including matters before administrative tribunals, affecting the municipality or local board

CARRIED

6.1 LeMine Update

Open Meeting (4:26 p.m.)

Ratify Actions Taken In Closed Session

Moved by: S. Lee

That all actions approved in the Closed Session be ratified.

CARRIED

The meeting recessed at 4:27 p.m.

The meeting resumed at 4:35 p.m.

5. Discussion

5.1 Council Chambers Modernization

N. Cooper and Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk, reviewed the contents of the written report and solicited feedback from the Committee. Members discussed the proposed design, lighting and acoustics, necessity of the project relative to other Town priorities, and alternatives for web streaming Council meetings. N. Cooper and A. Harras responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed the age and state of technology in the Council Chambers, potential design options, accessibility features, and alternatives for web streaming Council meetings.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the report titled 'Council Chambers Modernization' be received for information.

CARRIED

7. Presentations

7.1 Budget Workshop and Discussion

Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, discussed the objectives of the budget workshop and introduced Sandra Serrao, Acting Director of Finance. S. Serrao discussed the capital budget overview, engagement, process and timelines, how capital projects are funded, 2020 general levy allocations, slots and Elexicon revenues, 2020 allocation to reserves, Financial Sustainability Plan framework, 2019 long term debt and associated policies, capital budget pressures, spending cap objectives and guidelines, operating budget impacts, stormwater management, and current studies and master plans. Committee Members asked questions regarding funding sources for stormwater management. S. Baker discussed previous efforts to establish a dedicated stormwater management funding source and reviewed past budgeting practices.

N. Cooper reviewed the Information Technology Strategy and discussed major business system needs, workstation modernization, critical projects, shifting pressures from capital to operating budget, and staffing levels.

G. Romanowski reviewed the Downtown Community Improvement Plan (CIP), major accomplishments, upcoming and potential developments in the Downtown, development charge exemptions for the Medallion Development, future outlook and questions regarding the Downtown CIP, significant planning changes, and Bill 108.

Julie Mepham, Acting Manager of Budgets and Accounting, discussed development charges, at risk funding, and development charge reserve projected year end balances.

C. Bridgeman reviewed the Town's Asset Management practices and principles and the current status of the Town's Asset Management Plan. Committee Members asked questions regarding managing natural assets and the impacts of climate change. C. Bridgeman responded to questions from Committee Members.

S. Serrao reviewed the 2020 capital budget, project funding sources, funding from capital reserves, federal gas tax categories, usage and revenues, multi-year capital projects, new projects identified in the 2020-2024 capital budget, council requests, capital budget highlights, and upcoming public budget meetings.

Committee Members asked questions regarding allocation of surplus funds, capital reserve spending caps under the Financial Sustainability Plan, Paradise Park washrooms project, the Downtown CIP, use of gas tax funding for capital projects, funding for automated speed enforcement, and managing needs against maintaining reserves. Staff responded to questions. Committee Members thanked staff for the detailed presentation and information regarding the upcoming 2020 capital budget discussions.

Moved by: S. Lee

That the presentation titled 'Budget Workshop and Discussion' be received for information.

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (7:02 p.m.)

Moved by: A. Khan

That the November 11, 2019 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED

Chair

D-Clerk